

Course Title: Principle of Sociology

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Social Problem

- **Social Problem:**
- The term 'social problem' is usually taken to refer to social conditions that disrupt or damage society such as crime, racism, unemployment, poverty, violence, child abuse etc.
- Social problems are the general factors that affect and damage society.
- Social Problem is any condition or behavior that has negative consequences for large numbers of people and that is generally recognized as a condition or behavior that needs to be addressed.
- "Social problem is the outcome of social processes including a moral evaluation of peoples behavior."- **Collins Dictionary of Sociology, 2000**

► **Unemployment:**

- Unemployment is a state of worklessness for a man fit and willing to work that is a condition of involuntary and not voluntary idleness.

► It is largely concerned with those men and women who constitute the labor force of the country who are able-bodied and willing to work but are not gainfully employed.

- “Unemployment is defined as a condition in which an individual is not in a state of remunerative occupation despite his desire do so.”- **D’Mello**

- “Unemployment is the state of not being employed in paid work or self employed, even though available activity.”- **Collins Dictionary of Sociology, 2000**

Unemployment

- ▶ **The causes of Unemployment:**

- ▶ Enormous increase in population
- ▶ Defects in our education system
- ▶ Age factor
- ▶ Vocational unfitness
- ▶ Physical incapability's
- ▶ Technological advance
- ▶ Strike

- ▶ **The consequences of Unemployment:**

- ▶ Personal disorganization
- ▶ Family disorganization
- ▶ Irreparable economic losses

Poverty

► Poverty:

- Poverty is an economic condition in which one is unable to lead a minimum standard of living.
- Term poverty is derived from Latin word “pauper” which means ‘poor’.
- Poverty is the state of one who lacks a certain amount of material possession or money. It is a condition characterized by severe deprivation of basic human needs. It depends not only on income but also on access to services.
- “Poverty is the failure of basic capabilities to reach certain minimally acceptable levels.”- Amartya Sen, 1992
- “Poverty is the lack of sufficient material and cultural resources to sustain a healthy existence.”- **Collins Dictionary of Sociology, 2000**

The causes of poverty

- ▶ **The causes of poverty:**
- ▶ High population growth
- ▶ Illiteracy and ignorance
- ▶ Unemployment
- ▶ Natural disaster
- ▶ Underdeveloped agriculture
- ▶ Lack of proper industrialization
- ▶ Weak governance
- ▶ Political instability
- ▶ Rural urban migration

The consequences of poverty

▶ **The consequences of poverty:**

- ▶ Malnutrition and hunger
- ▶ Low literacy rate
- ▶ Homelessness
- ▶ Several diseases
- ▶ Child labor
- ▶ Poor living condition
- ▶ Sanitation problem
- ▶ Health problem
- ▶ Increase criminal activities
- ▶ Social disorganization

Measures to eradicate poverty in Bangladesh

- ▶ Control high population growth rate
- ▶ Increasing literacy rate
- ▶ Education system need to be job oriented
- ▶ To create employment opportunities
- ▶ Enhancing productivity in agricultural sector
- ▶ Encourage set up of small and cottage industries in rural areas
- ▶ Better transport and communication facilities
- ▶ Promoting gender equality and empowering women
- ▶ Ensuring good governance
- ▶ Eliminating corruption
- ▶ Exporting manpower
- ▶ Providing loans and technical education to the farmers.

Corruption

- ▶ **Corruption:**
- ▶ Corruption is a form of dishonesty or criminal offense undertaken by a person or organization entrusted with a position of authority to acquire illicit benefit or abuse power for one's private gain.
- ▶ It is the misuse of public power for personal gain, official position, rank or status for one's own. It has many different shapes as well as many various effects both on the economy and the society at large.
- ▶ “Corruption is an improper exercise of power and influence attached to a public office or to a special position in public life.”- **C.B. Mamoria**
- ▶ “Corruption is the abandonment of expected standards of behavior by those in authority for the sake of unsanctioned personal advantage.”- **Collins Dictionary of Sociology, 2000**

Corruption

▶ **The causes of corruption:**

- ▶ Economic insecurity
- ▶ High rate of income tax
- ▶ Emergence of new sources of wealth and power
- ▶ The system of democracy
- ▶ The very presence of black money
- ▶ Social and economic modernization

▶ **The consequences of corruption:**

- ▶ Decline of morality
- ▶ Social and economic inequalities
- ▶ Weaken administrative capacity
- ▶ Disturbance in democracy
- ▶ Criminal activities
- ▶ Unfair practice

Prevention of corruption

- ▶ **Prevention of corruption:**
- ▶ Law enforcement
- ▶ Modified taxation system
- ▶ Increasing the salary of govt. employers
- ▶ Maintaining consciousness
- ▶ Mass media and mass communication
- ▶ Minimizing bureaucratic corruption

Crime

- **Crime:**
- Crime is any act that violates a criminal law.
- It is socially harmful or dangerous and prohibited and punishable under criminal law.
- Ex- Stealing, murder, corruption etc.
- “Crime is an infraction of the criminal law.”- **David Jary and Julia Jary**

Crime

▶ **The causes of crime:**

- ▶ Economic insecurity
- ▶ High rate of population rate
- ▶ Unemployment
- ▶ Weaken administrative capacity
- ▶ Decline of morality

▶ **The consequences of crime:**

- ▶ Social disorganization
- ▶ Breakdown social stability
- ▶ Disturbance in democracy
- ▶ Increasing number of criminal activities.

Early marriage

- ▶ Article 2.4 of the Child Marriage Restraint Act, 2017 defines child marriage as “a marriage to which either or both of the contracting parties are minor”, where ‘minor’ (article 2.1) is defined as “in case of marriage, a person who, if a male, has not completed 21 (twenty-one) years of age, and if a female, has not completed 18 (eighteen) years of age.”

Factors of early marriage (Rani and Akmam (2022))

- ▶ Poverty
- ▶ Eve-teasing
- ▶ Lack of security
- ▶ Traditional custom
- ▶ Parental negligence
- ▶ Lack of girls' own interest in education
- ▶ Love affair
- ▶ Fear of losing beauty
- ▶ Fear of losing owner
- ▶ Teacher's maltreatment in school
- ▶ If a girl was more educated, it would create a problem to get an equally or better-qualified husband